

NORTHSTAR AUTOMATION CO.

AI Operations Audit

Prepared for

Harbor Lane Property Management

July 2026

SAMPLE REPORT — Harbor Lane Property Management is a fictional business used to demonstrate the deliverable. All figures are illustrative.

Findings

36.3 HOURS SAVED / MONTH	\$1,176.4 VALUE / MONTH	\$14,116.8 VALUE / YEAR	5 OPPORTUNITIES FOUND
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Guarantee met. This audit identifies 36.3 recoverable hours per month — above the 10-hour floor. If we hadn't found them, the audit would have been free.

BUSINESS SUMMARY

Harbor Lane manages 140 residential rental units for private landlords with a three-person team. Its biggest operational drag is manual intake: maintenance requests, rental applications, and monthly owner statements are re-keyed by hand across Buildium, QuickBooks, and spreadsheets. That administrative load is the main reason the team can't take on more units without hiring.

Opportunities, ranked by monthly value

#	OPPORTUNITY	HRS/MO	VALUE/MO	EFFORT
1	Maintenance request intake & triage	13.3	\$372.4	Medium
2	Monthly owner-statement assembly	5.0	\$300	High
3	Rent reminders & late-payment follow-up	9.0	\$252	Low
4	Applicant intake & screening data entry	5.0	\$140	Low
5	Move-in packet & onboarding	4.0	\$112	Low
Total		36.3	\$1,176.4	

The opportunities in detail

1

Maintenance request intake & triage

13.3 hrs/mo

\$372.4 /mo

Effort: **Medium**

HOW IT WORKS TODAY

About 40 maintenance requests arrive each month by voicemail, email, and text. The coordinator listens or reads, re-types each into Buildium as a work order, and decides urgency — roughly 20 minutes per request once follow-up questions are included.

WHAT TO BUILD

An n8n workflow captures requests from a dedicated phone line (Twilio) and the shared inbox, uses the Claude API to extract unit, issue, and urgency into a structured work order, and creates it in Buildium. The coordinator reviews a pre-filled queue and handles only flagged exceptions instead of typing every ticket.

TOOLS

n8n

Twilio

Claude API

Buildium

Basis: 40 requests/mo x ~20 min re-keyed & triaged each = 13.3 hrs.

2

Monthly owner-statement assembly

5.0 hrs/mo

\$300 /mo

Effort: **High**

HOW IT WORKS TODAY

Each month the owner compiles ~25 landlord statements by pulling figures from QuickBooks and Buildium and formatting them by hand — about 15 minutes apiece.

WHAT TO BUILD

A scheduled n8n flow pulls each owner's transactions, assembles the statement from a template, and drafts a short plain-language summary with the Claude API. The owner reviews and sends, rather than building each statement from scratch.

TOOLS

n8n

QuickBooks

Buildium

Claude API

Basis: 25 statements/mo x ~12 min saved each = 5.0 hrs.

3

Rent reminders & late-payment follow-up

9.0 hrs/mo

\$252 /mo

Effort: Low

HOW IT WORKS TODAY

The coordinator manually sends rent reminders to 140 tenants and chases roughly 18 late payers each month, tracking who has paid in a spreadsheet.

WHAT TO BUILD

An n8n schedule sends templated reminders three days before rent is due and escalates a friendly follow-up to anyone unpaid by the grace date, reading payment status from Buildium so no one is chased in error.

TOOLS

n8n

Buildium

Gmail

Basis: Reminder + late-chase workload ≈ 9.0 hrs/mo removed.

4

Applicant intake & screening data entry

5.0 hrs/mo

\$140 /mo

Effort: Low

HOW IT WORKS TODAY

About 15 applications a month are entered twice — once into Buildium and again into the screening portal — at roughly 25 minutes per applicant.

WHAT TO BUILD

An n8n workflow takes the submitted application, creates the applicant record in Buildium, and pushes the same details to the screening portal, leaving the coordinator to review results rather than key data twice.

TOOLS

n8n

Buildium

Google Sheets

Basis: 15 applications/mo x ~20 min double-entry saved = 5.0 hrs.

5

Move-in packet & onboarding

4.0 hrs/mo	\$112 /mo	Effort: Low
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HOW IT WORKS TODAY

For each of ~8 new tenants a month, the coordinator assembles the same move-in packet and setup tasks by hand — about 40 minutes each.

WHAT TO BUILD

An n8n flow triggers on a signed lease, generates the personalized move-in packet, sends it for e-signature, and creates the standard onboarding tasks automatically.

TOOLS

n8n	DocuSign	Buildium
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Basis: 8 onboardings/mo x ~30 min saved each = 4.0 hrs.

What we deliberately left alone

Good automation knows its limits. These are out of scope by design — several because you told us they must stay human.

Final approval of who to rent to	Client asked (Q15) that the rent/deny decision stay a human judgment call.
Handling upset tenants and eviction conversations	Client asked (Q15) that sensitive tenant conversations always stay with a real person.
Vacancy listing syndication to the 4 listing sites	Low volume (~6 vacancies/mo) and a past Zapier attempt duplicated listings (Q14); revisit only after the core builds are proven.

Your 90-day roadmap

DAYS 1–30

Build and prove the maintenance request intake & triage flow end to end — capturing phone, email, and text into structured Buildium work orders — and measure the real hours saved against the 13.3/month estimate.

DAYS 31–60

Add rent reminders & late-payment follow-up and applicant intake double-entry — both low-complexity quick wins — once the first flow is trusted.

DAYS 61–90

Automate monthly owner-statement assembly (the highest-effort build) and the move-in packet flow, then review measured savings and decide whether vacancy syndication is worth revisiting.

RECOMMENDED FIRST BUILD

Maintenance request intake & triage

It targets the team's single biggest time sink and carries the highest monthly value of any opportunity. At Medium complexity it's comfortably a two-week build, and proving it frees the coordinator immediately.

Fixed-price implementation · 2 weeks

\$1,500
fixed price

Methodology: Hours saved are estimated conservatively from the volume and frequency figures given in the intake questionnaire, and converted to dollars using the client's own fully-loaded hourly rates (Owner / broker \$60/hr, Leasing coordinator \$28/hr). Estimates assume a human still reviews exceptions, so realized savings are typically at or above these figures once a build is tuned. Figures are planning estimates, not guarantees of specific results.